

Tutorial I

1. How do managers contribute to the success of an organization?

Managers engage in many short, varied activities and frequently switch between tasks (Henry Mintzberg, John Kotter). They spend most of their time interacting with people—employees, supervisors, and external stakeholders. Around two-thirds of their time is communication (meetings, calls, conversations). Managers rarely work alone and often handle interruptions and unexpected issues.

Their role includes:

- Gathering information
- Building relationships
- Solving problems
- Coordinating work

Communication is the key tool for guiding actions and ensuring smooth operations. Managers achieve top performance by being active, adaptable, and highly connected through effective communication.

2. What are the roles that managers play in organizations?

The Roles Managers Play (Mintzberg's Roles)

Managers perform three main types of roles in organizations: interpersonal, informational, and decisional.

1. Interpersonal Roles

These involve interacting with people and building relationships. Managers act as:

Figurehead: perform ceremonial and symbolic duties.

Leader: motivate, guide, and manage employees.

Liaison: build networks and maintain contacts inside and outside the organization.

2. Informational Roles

Managers handle and share information. They act as:

Monitor: gather and analyze information from the environment.

Disseminator: share important information with employees.

Spokesperson: communicate information to external stakeholders and the public.

3. Decisional Roles

Managers make important organizational decisions. They act as:

Entrepreneur: initiate change and innovation.

Disturbance Handler: respond to crises and unexpected problems.

Resource Allocator: decide how to distribute limited resources.

Negotiator: handle negotiations with employees, suppliers, and other parties.

Overall, managers use these roles together to lead, communicate, and make decisions that help organizations achieve their goals.

3. What is the difference between programmed and nonprogrammed decisions?

Programmed Decisions

Programmed decisions are **routine, repeated, and structured decisions**.

- They are made in **regular situations that happen again and again**
- They follow **rules, procedures, or guidelines**
- The decision criteria are **known or can be predicted**

Examples:

- Ordering raw materials based on expected production and stock levels
- Scheduling part-time employees based on demand and availability

These decisions can be handled efficiently using established methods.

Nonprogrammed decisions

- **new, unstructured, and non-routine decisions** that are made in unusual or uncertain situations.
- They are based on **unclear or incomplete information**, so there are no fixed rules or procedures to follow.
- In these situations, managers must use **judgment, creativity, and careful thinking** to find the best possible solution. Because they require more effort and analysis, they are also called **high-involvement decisions**.
- Example :Deciding whether to adopt a **new technology**
 - Managers must consider:
 - Performance

- Competition
 - Future acceptance
- the manager must **collect as much information as possible and make an informed judgment.**

4. What are the two types of conflict? Which one is constructive, and which is destructive?

- a. **Process conflict:** Disagreement about how work should be done. This can be positive and lead to better solutions. It is considered **constructive conflict** because it encourages discussion, improves problem-solving, and can lead to better decisions and outcomes.
- b. **Relationship conflict:** Personal conflict between individuals. This is harmful and should be minimized. It is considered **destructive conflict** because it creates tension, reduces teamwork, and negatively affects performance and decision-making.

5. What are the benefits of decision-making in a group, instead of individually?

Advantages of Group Decision-Making

Diverse Perspectives

Different members bring varied views, experiences, and opinions.
Improves decision quality by considering multiple angles.

Reduced Bias

Group diversity helps minimize individual bias
Leads to fairer and more balanced decisions.

More Knowledge & Information

Each member contributes unique knowledge.
Enhances understanding of the problem.

More Ideas & Alternatives

Group discussions generate many ideas.
Brainstorming increases creative solutions.

Greater Commitment & Support

Involving affected people increases understanding.
Leads to stronger support and successful implementation.

6. What advantages do geographic structures have compared to a functional structure?

A **geographic structure** has several advantages compared to a **functional structure**. It enables organizations to respond more quickly to local market conditions, customer needs, and cultural differences because each regional unit operates semi-independently. It also provides better customer focus and allows products and services to be adapted to local markets. In addition, a geographic structure is highly suitable for large organizations operating in multiple regions or countries, as it improves coordination and management within each geographic area. In contrast, a functional structure focuses on specialization by department, but it may respond more slowly to regional market differences because decision-making is often centralized at headquarters.

7. What are some advantages and disadvantages of divisional structures?

Advantages of Divisional Structure

- Focuses on specific markets or business segments
- Improves specialization and budget control
- Clear roles and responsibilities
- Faster customer service
- Better coordination within divisions
- Supports decentralized decision-making
- Suitable for large organizations

Disadvantages of Divisional Structure

- Divisions may become isolated
- Poor communication between divisions
- Reduced coordination across the organization
- Different systems may create inefficiencies
- Difficult to maintain overall goals and consistency

